RRB NTPC - Graduate Level History Predictor Bank

Subject: Medieval Indian History & Deccan Kingdoms (Expanded/Updated Selection)
Target Exam: RRB NTPC Graduate Level (CBT 1 & CBT 2)

Question 1: Mughal Provincial Administration

Consider the following statements regarding the provincial administration system (*Suba*) during the height of the Mughal Empire and select the correct option:
Statement I: The *Subedar* was the executive head of the province and held direct responsibility for the maintenance of general law, order, and defense.
Statement II: The *Diwan* was the head of the provincial revenue department, functioned independently of the Subedar, and reported directly to the central imperial Wazir.

(A) Only Statement I is correct
(B) Only Statement II is correct
(C) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct
(D) Neither Statement I nor Statement II is correct

Correct Answer: (C) Both Statement I and Statement II are correct

Explanation: Under Emperor Akbar's structural consolidation, the empire was divided into provinces called *Subas*. To prevent local governors from becoming too powerful and launching rebellions, Akbar introduced a brilliant system of checks and balances. The *Subedar* (governor) was responsible for executive duties, military command, and keeping order, while the *Diwan* was an independent financial head managing revenue collection. Neither official could overrule the other, and the Diwan reported directly back to the central imperial capital.

Source / Heritage: *Primary Source: Abul Fazl's Ain-i-Akbari (Volume III) / NCERT Class 12 History. Exam Heritage: UPSC Civil Services Preliminary Exam, SSC CGL Tier-2, and RRB NTPC Graduate Level CBT-2 Pattern.*

Question 2: Mughal Revenue & Mansabdari Reforms

Consider the following statements regarding the administrative reforms introduced during the Mughal Empire:
1. Under the Dahsala or Zabti system introduced by Raja Todar Mal, the state collected land revenue based on the average produce and prices of the preceding ten years.
2. In the Mansabdari system, the Zat rank determined the absolute military obligations and the exact number of cavalrymen a mansabdar was required to maintain, while the Sawar rank indicated their personal status and salary.
3. Emperor Akbar completely abolished the Jizya tax on non-Muslims in 1564, which remained permanently revoked until the fall of the Mughal Empire.

(A) Only 1
(B) Only 1 and 2
(C) Only 2 and 3
(D) 1, 2, and 3

Correct Answer: (A) Only 1

Explanation: Statement 1 is correct: The Dahsala system surveyed crop yields, prices, and cultivated areas over a 10-year period (1570-1580), taking one-third of the average yield as the state's share in cash. Statement 2 is incorrect: The definitions are reversed. The Zat rank indicated personal status and salary, while the Sawar rank determined military strength obligations (number of cavalrymen). Statement 3 is incorrect: Akbar abolished Jizya in 1564, but it was later re-introduced by Emperor Aurangzeb in 1679, meaning it did not remain permanently revoked.

Source / Heritage: *Exam Heritage: SSC CGL Tier-2 GS Paper Pattern.*

Question 3: Sher Shah Suri's Secret Intelligence Network

Under the highly efficient administrative setup of Sher Shah Suri, which department was designated to handle the state intelligence, royal espionage networks, and the management of the imperial postal system (Dak Chauki)?

(A) Diwan-i-Insha
(B) Diwan-i-Arz
(C) Diwan-i-Barid
(D) Diwan-i-Rasalat

Correct Answer: (C) Diwan-i-Barid

Explanation: Sher Shah Suri established the Diwan-i-Barid, which was the official department for State Intelligence, Espionage, and Communications. The head of this department, the Barid-i-Mamalik, deployed intelligence officers (Barids) and secret news-writers (Munhis) across the kingdom. They used the horse-courier postal system (Dak Chauki) to report directly to the king.

Source / Heritage: *Exam Heritage: BPSC Combined Competitive (Preliminary) Exam, JPSC Combined Civil Services Exam.*

Question 4: Imperial Military Terminology

During the expansion of the Mughal Dynasty, the highly strategic and administrative branch regulating heavy field artillery, cannons, and matchlock muskets was generally designated under which institutional department?

(A) Diwan-i-Arz
(B) Top-khanah
(C) Mir Saman
(D) Dahsala

Correct Answer: (B) Top-khanah

Explanation: While Diwan-i-Arz was the overarching defense ministry inherited from the Delhi Sultanate era, the introduction of firearms and artillery by Babur changed the structure of the military. The specialized weapons division, which managed heavy field cannons and matchlocks, was organized into an independent department known as the Top-khanah. It was overseen directly by a dedicated superintendent (Mir-i-Atish).

Source / Heritage: *Primary Source: Zahiruddin Muhammad Babur's Tuzuk-i-Babri (Baburnama). Exam Heritage: SSC CGL Tier-1 shifts and highly prioritized in RRB NTPC Graduate Level exams.*

Question 5: The Modern Strategic City of the Deccan Sultanates

The Charminar is one of India's most iconic historical monuments, built to commemorate the eradication of a deadly plague. If you are standing directly beneath the arches of this monument today, which major medieval Deccan Sultanate's territory are you exploring?

(A) Adil Shahi Dynasty of Bijapur
(B) Nizam Shahi Dynasty of Ahmadnagar
(C) Qutb Shahi Dynasty of Golconda
(D) Imad Shahi Dynasty of Berar

Correct Answer: (C) Qutb Shahi Dynasty of Golconda

Explanation: The Charminar was built as the center point of the new capital city founded by the Qutb Shahi rulers when they moved away from their old, water-scarce fort city of Golconda. The dynasty represents one of the successor Deccan Sultanates that emerged following the splintering of the central Bahmani Kingdom.

Source / Heritage: *Exam Heritage: SSC CHSL / CPO SI Exam.*

Question 6: The Fractional Mansabdari Mechanics (Month-Scale System)

During the later phase of his reign, Emperor Shah Jahan introduced the Maha-Rana or Month-Scale system (Shash-Maha / Sih-Maha) within the Mansabdari framework. What was the primary structural purpose of this modification?

(A) To reduce the number of active months a soldier had to serve in the imperial guard.
(B) To proportionally reduce the cash salary of a Mansabdar if the actual revenue collection (Hasil) of their jagir fell short of the officially assessed revenue (Jama).
(C) To rotate Mansabdars between the administrative headquarters of Northern India and the military outposts of the Deccan every six months.
(D) To limit the inheritance rights of a noble's family over state-allotted properties.

Correct Answer: (B) To proportionally reduce the cash salary of a Mansabdar if the actual revenue collection (Hasil) of their jagir fell short of the officially assessed revenue (Jama).

Explanation: Under Shah Jahan, the gap between the expected revenue (Jama) and the actual collected revenue (Hasil) grew significantly. To keep the empire solvent without altering standard official ranks, Shah Jahan introduced the Month-Scale system. If a jagir yielded only half of its estimated revenue, it was designated a '6-month jagir,' and the Mansabdar's salary and military maintenance allowances were cut by 50%.

Source / Heritage: *Exam Heritage: UPSC Civil Services (Pre) Exam / SSC CGL Tier-2.*

Question 7: Administrative and Feudal Hierarchies

Under the highly centralized yet feudal Nayankara administrative framework of the Vijayanagara Empire, who among the following held the absolute ultimate ownership of all the land distributed to the Amaranayakas (military chiefs)?

(A) The local village assembly (Sabha)
(B) The Chief Finance Minister (Pradhani)
(C) The individual Amaranayaka by hereditary right
(D) The Emperor (Rayas)

Correct Answer: (D) The Emperor (Rayas)

Explanation: The Nayankara system was a cornerstone of Vijayanagara governance. The king (Raya) granted land tracts called Amaram to military commanders (Amaranayakas) in lieu of salary and to maintain a fixed army contingent for the state. However, the ultimate owner of the land remained the Emperor. The Amaranayakas were not hereditary lords; they were highly regulated land caretakers who could be transferred, demoted, or stripped of their lands by the king at any time.

Source / Heritage: *Exam Heritage: SSC CGL Tier-1 / UPSC / State PCS Prelims.*

Question 8: The Mansabdari Fractional System (Du-Aspah Sih-Aspah)

The highly specialized Du-aspah Sih-aspah system, which effectively doubled the military obligations and cavalry strength of selected nobles without altering their primary structural Zat rank, was introduced by which Mughal Emperor?

(A) Akbar
(B) Jahangir
(C) Shah Jahan
(D) Aurangzeb

Correct Answer: (B) Jahangir

Explanation: While Akbar founded the basic Mansabdari framework (consisting of Zat for status/pay and Sawar for cavalry count), Jahangir introduced the Du-aspah Sih-aspah feature. Literally meaning 'two-horse three-horse,' it allowed the state to double a trusted commander's military troops (Sawar) without altering their base ranking (Zat), saving the imperial treasury immense administrative costs.

Source / Heritage: *Exam Heritage: UPPSC Combined State Services, BPSC Prelims, and MPPSC General Studies.*

Question 9: Mughal Administrative Hierarchy

During the reign of Mughal Emperor Akbar, who held the administrative charge of the military department, controlled recruitment, and was responsible for handling the pay bills of the Mansabdars?

(A) Wazir
(B) Mir Bakshi
(C) Mir Saman
(D) Sadr-us-Sudur

Correct Answer: (B) Mir Bakshi

Explanation: The Mir Bakshi was the head of the military department under the Mughal administration. He was the supreme authority for checking the branding of imperial horses (Dagh) and verified the cavalry contingents (Sawar) before approving salaries, making him a central figure in Akbar's Mansabdari System.

Source / Heritage: *Exam Heritage: UPPSC Combined State Services (Pre), BPSC Prelims, and SSC CGL Tier-1.*

Question 10: Mughal Architecture and Capitals

Which Mughal Emperor formally transferred the primary imperial capital of the empire from Agra to Delhi in 1638 AD by constructing the new walled city of Shahjahanabad?

(A) Akbar
(B) Jahangir
(C) Shah Jahan
(D) Aurangzeb

Correct Answer: (C) Shah Jahan

Explanation: While Akbar originally fortified the Agra Fort, it was Shah Jahan who decided to move the center of power to Delhi in 1638. He commissioned the creation of a grand new capital city named Shahjahanabad and built the Red Fort and the Jama Masjid to secure it.

Source / Heritage: *Exam Heritage: MPSC State Services Preliminary Exam, WBCS Executive Exam.*